INDUSTRY RESEARCH CONDENSED REPORT

2024



terrasmart™

BUS 102 SEC FB

Prepared By:
Reagan Henkel

word count: 799

INTRODUCTION

OBJECTIVE

As solar paneling is known as a renewable energy source, it appeals as an environmentally friendly, sustainable way of providing power to individuals worldwide.Throughout this report, I will provide information as to the history of Terrasmart, a non-residential solar mounting company. By taking a deeper dive into the history of Terrasmart, its parent company Gibraltar Industries, as well as the current products and projects Terrasmart has produced, a greater understanding of the potential of this company in the world today will be understood. Underutilized, Terrasmart has the potential and need to grow beyond its current benchmark, and expand to its greatest potential.



History

Terrasmart is a solar mounting company, founded by Ryan Reid, after he heard that the government was investing in renewables in 2009 (Ryan C. Reid, n.d.). It has provided solar mounting for panels in various environments, and has become known for its sustainability, and reliability. Under parent company Gibraltar Industries, a lead manufacturing company for renewable energy in the residential, industrial, as well as renewable energy market, Terrasmart has been introduced to new resources, industries, and customers worldwide, providing them with great potential to grow their presence throughout the renewable energy industry (Gibraltar Industries – We Build Companies That Make an Impact in the World!, n.d.).

PRODUCTS

The Fixed Tilt offers a reliable solution to solar power needs, as it has a quick and easily sustainable installation appealing to any terrain or angular surface. It appeals to customers with desires for solar paneling on hilly or tree dense land as it can adapt, and be installed in a way that is sustainable for those conditions. The Tracker is a solar paneling system that tracks the sun's movement, and maximizes the energy intake of the panels. It appeals to customers that want and need more energy for fueling their necessities. Canopy solar paneling is a covering made of solar paneling that generates energy as well as providing a covering for cars and other objects. It is desirable for large parking lots, found at large corporations, schools, or other facilities. Next is eBos which offers Combiners, Wire Solutions, Recombiners, Disconnect Enclosures, and Battery Connection Panels, which is helpful in energy production.This helps elaborates and enhances the panel's performance, and helps in consumer gains. SIFT helps identify the right fit for consumers when it comes to solar paneling. This is helpful for people who aren't familiar with the products at hand, and leads to the most beneficial outcome.

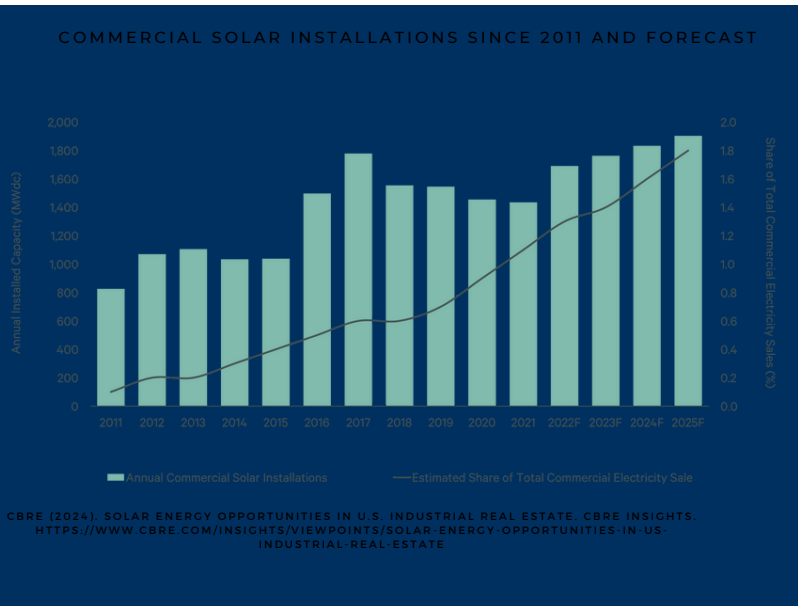
PROJECTS

According to Terrasmart's website, they have been involved in a variety of different projects. Agrivoltaic projects for Terrasmart consist of solar panel installations and practices involving agriculture, including farms or crops. Terrasmart helped farmers in Southern Massachusetts collect solar energy over cranberry bogs using eBos. Commercial projects include solar panel installation on commercial buildings and facilities. Terrasmart installed a solar garage canopy in Morrisville, NC. Community solar consists of paneling installation that benefits a community as whole, and individuals within. Terrasmart hasn't participated in this type of project yet. Education projects are ones where solar panels are installed at educational facilities like high schools or colleges. Terrasmart installed canopy solar paneling in the parking lot at Upper Cape Cod Technical High School in Massachusetts. Public sector projects are solar installations on government owned property. Terrasmart hasn't done this type of project yet. Utility projects are large solar installations made to generate power directly to the grid.Terrasmart installed a glide wave solar panel in Ivanhoe, NC.

ADVANTAGES VS DISADVANTAGES

Some advantages to solar paneling include less spending on electricity, personal and independent sources of energy, as well as producing electricity in an environmentally safe and sustainable manner. Some disadvantages include maintenance of the panels, reliability on the weather and environmental factors for power, as well as intimidating upfront prices. Overall, the benefits outweigh the drawbacks, as it is an eco-friendly, reliable energy source. As it gains more attention to the public, there is great potential for solutions to the disadvantages to be developed. Additionally, there are many options at hand where consumers can find the best fit for them to fit their needs, increasing personal benefits.

CONCLUSION



CBRE (2024). SOLAR ENERGY OPPORTUNITIES IN U.S. INDUSTRIAL REAL ESTATE. CBRE INSIGHTS. HTTPS://WWW.CBRE.COM/INSIGHTS/VIEWPOINTS/SOLAR-ENERGY-OPPORTUNITIES-IN-US-INDUSTRIAL-REAL-ESTATE

The main barrier for expansion of solar technologies to the commercial market is initial cost. The amount of money needed to pay upfront is greater than the average household can spend. Additionally, space is an issue for many people with commercial properties, as the solar paneling can take up space that consumers don't have. While that's disencouraging, the demand for solar paneling, and its popularity are both on the rise, and are projected to increase even further this year, as shown in the graph. This opens a door for the renewable energy industry, and specifically Terrasmart to tweak prices, or come up with more attainable solutions and products for the commercial audience. By understanding, and accommodating to the wants of the average individual household, Terrasmart can expand and grow into more than just a non-residential company..

SOURCES

CAS - CENTRAL AUTHENTICATION SERVICE. (N.D.). AUTH.MIAMIOH.EDU. HTTPS://MY-IBISWORLD-COM.PROXY.LIB.MIAMIOH.EDU/US/EN/INDUSTRY-SPECIALIZED/OD4494/AT-A-GLANCE

GIBRALTAR INDUSTRIES – WE BUILD COMPANIES THAT MAKE AN IMPACT IN THE WORLD! (N.D.). HTTPS://WWW.GIBRALTAR1.COM/

PROJECTS · TERRASMART. (N.D.). TERRASMART.HTTPS://WWW.TERRASMART.COM/PROJECTS/

RYAN C. REID. (N.D.). GULFSHORE BUSINESS. HTTPS://WWW.GULFSHOREBUSINESS.COM/40_UNDER_40/RYAN-C-REID/

TERRASMART. (2023). SOLAR TECHNOLOGY | POWERFUL CONNECTIONS. TERRASMART. HTTPS://WWW.TERRASMART.COM/

UNION OF CONCERNED SCIENTISTS. (2017, DECEMBER 20). BARRIERS TO RENEWABLE ENERGY TECHNOLOGIES. UNION OF CONCERNED SCIENTISTS; UNION OF CONCERNED SCIENTISTS. HTTPS://WWW.UCSUSA.ORG/RESOURCES/BARRIERS-RENEWABLE-ENERGY-TECHNOLOGIES